

The Garamut
"The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'!

For PRAYER, PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL PROGRESS

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Theme: What shall this man do? What about this man?

- **If we are not vigilant (watchful), Christianity can become something that is just general, impersonal, abstract and detached, more OBJECTIVE, than SUBJECTIVE.**
  - **The word Objective means not influenced by personal feelings or opinions in considering and representing facts.**
  - **The word Subjective (based on or influenced by personal feelings, tastes, or opinions).**

The overview of the story in John 21:17-22 *NET.*

In reading the passage in John 21:17-22 where Peter and Jesus meet on the seashore of Galilee and engaged in the subject of whether Peter loved Jesus.

*17 Jesus said a third time, "Simon, son of John, do you love me?" Peter was distressed that Jesus asked him a third time, **"Do you love me?"** and said, "Lord, you know everything. You know that I love you." Jesus replied, **"Feed my sheep.***

And then the conversation led into Jesus stating about Peter's life and what would happen to him in the future.

18 "I tell you the truth, when you were young, you were able to do as you liked; you dressed yourself and went wherever you wanted to go. But when you are old, you will stretch out your hands, and others will dress you and take you where you don't want to go."

19 Jesus said this to let him know by what kind of death he would glorify God. Then Jesus told him, "Follow me".

Then Peter noticed that the Apostle John was standing nearby and so he asked Jesus the following question - *"What about this man Lord" - "What about him, Lord?"*

And Jesus replied – *"what concern is that of yours"* – Literally ("it is not your business (or mine) what is going to happen in the life of another person"). The command to you Peter is for you to FOLLOW ME.

*20 Peter turned around and **saw behind them the disciple Jesus loved – (John)** the one who had leaned over to Jesus during supper and asked, "Lord, who will betray you?"*

*21 So when Peter saw him, he asked Jesus, **"Lord, what about him?"***

*22 Jesus replied, "If I want him to live until I come back, **what concern is that of yours?** – **"You follow me!"** NET.*

- **THE ANSWER JESUS GAVE TO PETER - *"follow me"* IS ALSO TRUE AND RELEVANT FOR US TODAY.**

THE APPLICATION for our lives:

- **Regardless of the events and circumstances we encounter in life - storms, trials, joys and victories, our primary call is to follow Jesus.**
- **"This also means remaining steadfast in our commitment to follow Christ, regardless of how it impacts or affects those around us, including friends and family."**

GOD PLANS OUR PATHWAYS AND THAT IS WHY THEY ARE DIFFERENT FOR EACH BELIEVER.

- **God's Word teaches us that the pathways, or steps of a person are ORDERED (determined) by the Lord.**

Psalms 37:23 The steps of a good man are ordered by the Lord: and he delighteth in his way. KJV
Psalms 37:23 The Lord directs the steps of the godly. He delights in every detail of their lives. NLT

OUR PATHWAYS ARE DETERMINED BY GOD.

- ***Ephesians 2:10 For we are God's masterpiece. He has created us anew in Christ Jesus, so we can do the good things he planned for us long ago. NLT.***
- ***Ephesians 1:11 Furthermore, because we are united with Christ, we have received an inheritance from God, for he chose us in advance, and he makes everything work out according to his plan. NLT.***
- ***Romans 8:29 For God knew his people in advance, and he chose them to become like his Son, so that his Son would be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters. NLT.***
- ***Esther 4:14 If you keep quiet at a time like this, deliverance and relief for the Jews will arise from some other place, but you and your relatives will die. Who knows if perhaps you were made queen for just such a time as this?" NLT.***

WHILE EACH BELIEVER'S PATHWAY IS DIFFERENT THERE ARE COMMON ASPECTS THAT ARE INCLUDED IN ALL – ESPECIALLY THE COMMAND TO FOLLOW JESUS.

Example

- **To be obedient in carrying out Christ's global commission.**
- **To be faithful, loving, kind, compassionate, considerate and willing to sacrifice and face adversity.**
- **The discovery of where and what each path reveals belongs to those who remain surrendered, committed and following Jesus.**
- **So, those things that happen to us could be quite different to someone else simply because our pathways have been divinely ordained that way. *Romans 8:28 "called according to his purpose". WEB***

This makes each pathway personal (not private – but personal) and specifically related to you and the commission that God has given you, and knowing this helps us to manage and process what is taking place in our lives, (both the good and no good).

PETER'S JOURNEY (of life & death) WAS TO BE DIFFERENT TO THAT OF JOHN'S; BUT REGARDLESS OF WHAT THEY WOULD EACH FACE, THEY WERE BOTH COMMANDED TO CONTINUE TO FOLLOW JESUS.

THAT IS WHY OUR CHRISTIANITY NEEDS TO BE PERSONAL (not private) but personal – *meaning related to you and God's calling and mandate placed upon you.*

- **Because your journey is a personal one you can draw a sense of comfort and worth in knowing that it was your Heavenly Father who specifically chose it for you.**
- **Therefore, it is not wise to compare our journey with others because it is personally and individually designed for you.**

HAVE YOU GIVEN THOUGHT TO THE TRUTH THAT SOME OF THE THINGS THAT HAPPEN TO US MAY WELL BE FOR THE BENEFIT OF OTHERS.

And the apostle Paul writes that the purpose of the trials, testings, oppositions that he and other believers faced was also for the benefit of others.
2 Corinthians 4:11-12
11 Yes, we live under constant danger of death because we serve Jesus, so that the life of Jesus will be evident in our dying bodies.
*12 So we live in the face of death, **but this has resulted in eternal life for you.** NLT.*
*2 Corinthians 5:16 For God caused Christ, who himself knew nothing of sin, actually to be sin **for our sakes,** so that in Christ **we might be made good.***

LET'S MAKE OUR DEVOTION AND SERVICE SOMETHING PERSONAL SO THAT IT HAS MEANING AND RELEVANCE FOR US PERSONALLY.
Amen Ps Barry